

PAUSTIK / USER GUIDE

Using the Paustik app

A practical guide for customers, mother entrepreneurs, delivery agents, and administrators.

Prepared for the Paustik pilot

This document describes the app as it exists in the current build and marks preview-only and planned capabilities clearly. Do not treat sample listings or values as live offers.

1. Start here

Open the Paustik website and choose Create account. Select Customer, Mother entrepreneur, or Delivery agent. Admin accounts are managed from the Admin portal and are not part of public sign-up.

Choose a verification channel

- Enter a phone number with country code. Indian numbers can be entered as 10 digits or with +91.
- Choose SMS or WhatsApp, then select Send code. Production delivery requires Paustik's Twilio Verify credentials. WhatsApp also needs an approved sender configured on the Verify Service.
- In preview mode, the one-time code is shown on the page and no text message is sent. This is for testing only and does not prove phone ownership.
- Enter the 6-digit code and finish the form. Your account is stored in the configured database; a local development run without a hosted database stores it in a local SQLite file.

Preview code reminder

Do not rely on the on-page code for a public launch. It is visible to anyone testing the preview. For production sign-in, disable demo auth and configure Twilio Verify.

2. What each role can do

Role	During account creation	After approval / sign-in
Customer	Name, phone, email and delivery address.	Customer dashboard shows saved orders and meal plans, plus approved nearby kitchens when available. If none are live, it shows clearly marked sample kitchens.
Mother entrepreneur	Kitchen name, cooking specialties, daily meal capacity, lunch days, service window and address.	The application is saved as pending review. Menu publishing and real marketplace orders are not active yet.
Delivery agent	Contact details, address and vehicle type.	The application is pending. Marketplace dispatch is not connected. The separate tracking pilot is available for controlled testing.
Admin	Created through the protected Admin area by an active administrator; first-admin provisioning is an operator setup step.	Admin dashboard summarizes stored accounts, orders, income and payouts. Empty sections mean no matching production records exist.

3. Customer discovery and orders

From the customer dashboard, use Find your next lunch to review kitchen name, neighbourhood, cuisine, rating and example dishes with prices. Sample Bhubaneswar listings are labelled as samples. Selecting a sample opens the separate menu preview, which stores its cart in that browser only.

- The dashboard can show verified and accepting kitchens from PostgreSQL when kitchen records and available meals are present.
- Sample listings are not real mother businesses and sample prices are not current Paustik offers.
- Checkout, payment capture, refunds, subscriptions, live ratings and marketplace delivery assignment are not enabled in this build. No live order is placed from the sample menu.

4. Mother and delivery onboarding

Mother applications save kitchen capacity and lunch availability to the kitchen profile. Keep the information accurate; a Paustik administrator must review the kitchen before it can appear as a live listing. The current sign-up form is the application step, not a complete menu-management workspace.

Delivery agents can register and await approval. For the separate tracking pilot, operations creates a trip using the delivery admin page, and the courier opens the secure courier link, grants foreground location access, and confirms handover with the recipient code. This pilot is not linked to customer marketplace orders.

5. Admin operations

Select Admin portal from the site footer. Existing administrator sign-in uses the protected administrator credentials. Inside the admin area, account management is available to active admins. The first administrator must be provisioned by the site operator using the database setup procedure; never make open public administrator registration available.

The income view reads saved order, earning, payment and payout records. It will show zero or empty lists until real records exist. Sample menu activity does not create financial records.

6. Database tools

For the current Neon PostgreSQL project, start with Neon Console Tables for viewing and careful record edits. Prisma Studio is the project-matched visual editor for PostgreSQL and the local SQLite preview. DBeaver Community is a free desktop option for PostgreSQL. The Neon natural-language MCP agent can help in a development branch, but Neon advises review of every action and limiting it to development and testing.

- Use a Neon development branch for experiments and sample data.
- Prefer read-only credentials when exploring production data.
- Keep database URLs and API keys in server-side environment settings; do not paste them into screenshots, chat, or public code.

7. Help and troubleshooting

Open Help videos in the footer for role walkthroughs and written transcripts. If WhatsApp fails, choose SMS or ask the operator to enable an approved WhatsApp sender in Twilio Verify. If an account appears pending, it is waiting for review. If your customer activity is empty, the account may have no saved orders or plans yet.

Useful links

Twilio Verify: [API and channels](#) | [WhatsApp sender setup](#) | [Neon MCP safety](#)